

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with a year of practical experience supporting contentious matters at BCLP across international arbitration and real estate disputes, complemented by ongoing case management work at Citizens Advice and earlier exposure to contractual review and data protection at Adobe. Experienced in reviewing evidence, preparing hearing bundles, drafting procedural documents and correspondence, maintaining organised case files, tracking deadlines and communicating with clients on sensitive matters. Completing an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution at Queen Mary, with a strong interest in dispute resolution practice across commercial and private client contexts.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration through its procedural stages: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial, amended memorial sections and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior on the matter shortly before a significant deadline; coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions across the team and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines, using iManage to maintain matter records
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons

- Prepared client notes and maintained matter records throughout

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages cases from initial client interview through to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies the relevant legal and evidential issues across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines across a concurrent caseload
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; researches complex points and identifies evidential gaps
- Communicates procedural requirements and options clearly to clients in vulnerable situations, translating complex rules into practical guidance

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the submission deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report writing; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; iManage; legal research databases; case management and time-recording systems; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters